

**BEFORE THE BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS BOARD
OF THE STATE OF IOWA**

RE: Independent Social Work License of LINDA MORAN License No. 00941 RESPONDENT	CASE NO.: 23-0465 SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND FINAL ORDER
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COMES NOW the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals (“Board”) and Linda Moran (“Respondent”), pursuant to Iowa Code §§ 17A.10(2), 272C.3(4), and chapter 154C, enter into this Settlement Agreement and Final Order (“Settlement Agreement”).

A. BACKGROUND

1. **Iowa License.** Respondent was issued no. 00941 to practice social work at the independent level on January 18, 1994. Respondent’s license is active and next expires on December 31, 2026.
2. **Practice Setting.** Respondent practiced social work in or around Council Bluffs, Iowa during the time-period relevant to these allegations.
3. **Jurisdiction.** The Board has jurisdiction in this matter pursuant to Iowa Code chapters 17A, 147, 154C, and 272C as well as 645 Iowa Administrative Code chapter 283.
4. **Statement of Charges:** On July 29, 2025, the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals voted to file a Statement of Charges alleging Respondent violated Iowa Administrative Code rules 645—283.2(29(b)(3) (COUNT I), 645—283.2(3)(4) (COUNT II), and 645—283.2(6)(a)(5) (COUNT III).
5. **Allegations.** Respondent provided mental health services at a nonprofit organization in Council Bluffs, Iowa until approximately November 2023. Respondent supervised Employee A, a provisionally licensed mental health counselor (T-LMHC). On or about December 15, 2023,

Respondent and Employee A met for dinner at a restaurant in Omaha. After the meal, Respondent was too intoxicated to drive, so she left her car at the restaurant and went to Employee A's house. That evening, Respondent propositioned Employee A for sex. While at Employee A's house, Respondent fell and cut her leg. Employee A took Respondent to the emergency room for stitches. Respondent apologized to Employee A for her behavior the following morning. In subsequent text messages, Respondent also acknowledged that she had made a sexual advance to Employee A.

6. Respondent was charged with OWI 2nd in May of 2025. She underwent a substance abuse evaluation on June 10, 2025 and is currently completing treatment.

B. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT

7. Respondent stipulates the allegations stated above, if proven in a contested case hearing, would constitute grounds for the discipline agreed to in this Settlement Agreement.

8. In order to resolve this matter without proceeding to a contested case hearing, Respondent consents to the discipline as outlined in section C.

9. This Settlement Agreement constitutes discipline against Respondent and is the final agency action in a contested case pursuant to Iowa Code § 17A.10.

10. Respondent shall submit a copy of this Settlement Agreement to all licensing boards where Respondent holds a license, whether active or not, no later than **THIRTY DAYS** following the date this Settlement Agreement is approved by the Board.

11. This Settlement Agreement shall not preclude the Board from taking additional action against Respondent should Respondent violate laws, rules, or standards of practice administered by the Board in the future.

12. In entering this Settlement Agreement, Respondent acknowledges the following:

a. This Order is subject to the approval of the Board and will have no force or effect if it

is not accepted by the Board.

- b. Counsel for the State will present this Order to the Board *ex parte*.
- c. Respondent has the right to be represented by counsel.
- d. Respondent has a right to contest the allegations in a contested case. By waiving the hearing, Respondent waives her right to a hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to seek judicial review of this Order.
- e. Failure to comply with the provisions of this Settlement Agreement shall be grounds for further disciplinary action pursuant to Iowa Code § 272C.3(2)(a).
- f. Respondent is responsible for all expenses incurred to comply with the conditions and requirements of this Settlement Agreement.
- g. The Board is required by federal law to report this Order to the National Practitioner Databank. The report will reflect the language in this Order.

13. This Order constitutes a final order of the Board and the resolution of a contested case.

When fully executed, it becomes a public record available for inspection and copying upon execution in accordance with of Iowa Code Chapters 17A, 22, and 272C.

C. FINAL ORDER

WHEREFORE, the terms of this Settlement Agreement are agreed to by the Iowa Board of Behavioral Health Professionals and the Respondent. The Board concludes the allegations set forth above constitute grounds for discipline. For these reasons and by the agreement of the parties, **THE BOARD HEREBY ORDERS:**

EVALUATION ORDER: Respondent shall provide a full and complete copy of the completed substance abuse evaluation to the Board within **30 DAYS** of this Order. Respondent shall comply with all recommendations in the evaluation report, including follow-up treatment.

Respondent shall send a copy of any discharge documents and other proof of treatment completion to the Board upon completion.

EDUCATION REQUIRED. Respondent shall complete a continuing education course on navigating professional boundaries through PBI Education or another comparable course. The course must be approved by the Board prior to completion and must be completed within **ninety (90) days** of the date of this Order. Respondent shall submit proof of completion of the course to the Board upon completion.

PROBATION AND PRACTICE MONITORING. Respondent's license to practice mental health counseling in the state of Iowa is placed on **PROBATION** for at least **36 MONTHS** from the date of this Order. Respondent's probationary term is subject to the following conditions:

- a. *Practice Monitor.* Respondent shall submit the name and credentials of a proposed practice monitor within **30 DAYS** of the date this Settlement Agreement is approved by the Board. The proposed practice monitor must be a licensed mental health provider in Iowa with no disciplinary history and have at least 5 years of experience. The practice monitor may not work at the same organization/business as Respondent.
- b. After receiving approval of the practice monitor from the Board's Executive, Respondent shall meet with the practice monitor to discuss this Settlement Agreement and the circumstances that led to discipline. Respondent and practice mentor shall also discuss establishing and maintaining boundaries with clients and other relevant topics. Following this meeting, Respondent shall submit a narrative report to the Board describing the conversation, the best practices discussed, and Respondent's plans to implement best practices moving forward. Respondent shall

submit this report no later than **90 DAYS** following the date this Settlement Agreement is approved by the Board.

- c. After the initial meeting with the practice monitor, Respondent shall meet with the practice monitor on a quarterly basis, at a minimum. The meetings may be in person or virtual. During those meetings, Respondent and practice monitor shall discuss Respondent's progress on implementing the best practices previously discussed and any barriers or challenges that have arisen. The practice monitor shall also review a random sample of Respondent's progress notes for client appointments and communications with clients during each meeting to identify any concerns. The monitor will discuss any concerns with Respondent (and report to the Board if warranted). The practice monitor may require Respondent to complete readings or other assignments relevant to the facts underlying this case or other practice concerns ahead of scheduled meetings. Upon receipt of a report from Respondent's practice mentor indicating concerns with Respondent's practice or recommending future monitoring or practice restrictions, the Board may open a new complaint.
- d. Respondent shall ensure the practice monitor submits a **QUARTERLY** written report to the Board regarding the clinical practice review and confirming Respondent's compliance with this Settlement Agreement. The practice monitor's reports are due January 1, April 1, July 1, and October 1 each year.
- e. Respondent shall submit a **QUARTERLY** written report providing a short overview of the work done with her practice monitor. Reports are due January 1, April 1, July 1, and October 1 each year.

- f. All quarterly reports made to the Board by Respondent and the practice monitor are confidential and not part of this Settlement Agreement.
- g. Respondent shall be responsible for any costs associated with the practice monitor.
- h. Respondent shall appear before the Board upon reasonable notice.
- i. During the probationary period, Respondent shall not provide supervision to provisionally licensed individuals performing counseling services.
- j. Termination of probation is subject to approval of the Board upon the Board's finding that Respondent has complied with the terms of this Settlement Agreement to the Board's satisfaction.

FOR THE RESPONDENT:

Voluntarily agreed to and accepted by Linda Moran on this 2nd day of December, 2025.

Linda S. Moran, LISW, CADC
Linda S. Moran, LISW, CADC (Dec 2, 2025 14:46:34 CST)

By: Linda Moran, Respondent

FOR THE IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS:

Voluntarily agreed to and accepted by the **IOWA BOARD OF BEHAVIORAL HEALTH PROFESSIONALS** January 27, 2026.

Aaron L. Culley, LISW

Board Chair
Board of Behavioral Health Professionals